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Title:

How Much I Love You

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(PRESENT; best friends Charlotte and Lucy are sitting together; Charlotte is sitting up in a bed; Lucy sits next to her)
LUCY: So...what do you want to do?
CHARLOTTE: I don't know. This is kind of a slumber party, right? What do girls do at a slumber party?
LUCY: I have literally no idea.
CHARLOTTE: Gosh, I haven't been to a slumber party since I was like eight.
LUCY: You've *been* to one. I was so uncool when we were eight that people's *moms* wanted me to stay home.
CHARLOTTE: You did listen to a lot of NPR.
LUCY: Okay, radio is fascinating! It's an art form, Char. Don't look at me like that; it is a seriously underappreciated art form, and I personally think that if more people --
CHARLOTTE: (*cuts her off)* Lucy. Too much. Too far. This is one of those times I mentioned.
LUCY: National Public Radio is interesting!
CHARLOTTE: Yes. I'm sure a lot of 800 year old men would agree with you.
LUCY: Okay, that's rude.
CHARLOTTE: The truth hurts, babe. Tell me something exciting; I'm living vicariously here.
LUCY: Something exciting about *my* life? Grasping at straws there, Char.
CHARLOTTE: Come on - anything! Find me a straw!
LUCY: *(considers; hesitates)*….I went on a date last week.
CHARLOTTE: *(excited)* Oooohhh!
LUCY: *(deadpan)* He's a part-time civil war reenactor.
CHARLOTTE: *(confused)* Oohhh?
LUCY: *(clearly embarrassed)* Got a beard. Like a long one. They asked him to remove his gun before we entered the Chilli's.
CHARLOTTE: He took you to *Chilli's*?
LUCY: He had a gun, Charlotte! Focus. Gun. Civil war era gun. Wore the gun. On the date.
CHARLOTTE: The date where he took you to *Chilli's*.
LUCY: Charlotte, he is a civil war reenactor. He wore his civil war musket on our date! There are clearly bigger issues here!
CHARLOTTE: But I just think Chilli's is so tacky, ya know?
LUCY: Charlotte!
CHARLOTTE: Yes, okay. Bad. But I mean...probably not the worst date you've ever been on. Remember that guy in college? With the...hike, and the uh...shoulder?
LUCY: Oh, Brad. Yeah. THAT was a doozy.

<u>FLASHBACK *(Lucy and Brad are hiking).*</u>
LUCY: *(out of breath)* Uh...Brad, could we maybe...slow down? Bra- Brad?
BRAD: *(clearly annoyed)* Oh. Uh, yeah. You seem a little...tired.

LUCY: No, yeah. I'm good - it's just that I...I sprained my ankle a couple miles back, and I think it's...is it possible for that to bleed? Something is definitely bleeding.
BRAD: Right, yeah. I dunno. So...you're not really the hiking type then, huh?
LUCY: Well...I thought I did okay up until, you know...well the jump over the stream was a little steep. *(notices elbow)* Oh. Yep, there's the blood.
BRAD: *(pointing at her arm)* Yeah. That's not hangin' right.
LUCY: I'm sorry?
BRAD: Looks like that shoulder's dislocated.
LUCY: Oh dear!
BRAD: *(cracking knuckles)* I can probably pop her back in for 'ya if you want. *(tries to grab her shoulder)*
LUCY: Or! Or you know...we could...see a doctor.
BRAD: I mean we're kind of on a time crunch.
LUCY: Sure, yes. And if it was just the shoulder, but my ankle and...wait, why the time crunch?
BRAD: 50 cent wings start at five. I told you this. We gotta meet the guys. At five.
LUCY: Right, wings, yeah...but...I think a doctor is a good idea.
BRAD: Yeah, I guess I could call 'ya an ambulance.
LUCY: Can't you just drive me?
BRAD: Lucy, I got Wing Wednesdays!

<u>PRESENT</u>
LUCY: Yeah, that was a bad one.
CHARLOTTE: Definitely not a contender.
LUCY: Senior prom with Bobby Pickett was probably my best date.
CHARLOTTE: Right! He got you the yellow flowers. I went with Mike Hart that year.
LUCY: Yeah, you stole him from Gretchen Judge.
CHARLOTTE: She ripped out my hair extensions. I still have the scar.
LUCY: Your mom was *so* mad about those hair extensions.
CHARLOTTE: Not as mad as YOUR mom was when we tried to *sell* Marcus.
LUCY: I don't know why: nobody would have paid money for Marcus.
CHARLOTTE: Probably because she's a mom; worrying is in the job description.
LUCY: You're a mom. You like being a mom right?
CHARLOTTE: Being a mom is cool.
LUCY: You remember how you felt about it before you were one?
CHARLOTTE: I freaked out a little.
LUCY: A little?

<u>FLASHBACK</u>
(*rapid knocking; Lucy answers the door, very obviously was sleeping; Charlotte barges in, very pregnant)*
CHARLOTTE: I changed my mind.
LUCY: Charlotte? It's three in the morning. What are you doing here?

CHARLOTTE: I changed my mind!
LUCY: Where is Luke?
CHARLOTTE: Sleeping pleasantly because he doesn't have a bowling ball attached to his front!
LUCY: Okay. And you're here because?
CHARLOTTE: I changed my mind, Luce!
LUCY: About?
CHARLOTTE: I can't do this! This mom thing. I changed my mind. It's not happening.
LUCY: No, I'm pretty sure it's happening.
CHARLOTTE: I can't be someone's mother! I can't even throw out that crop top from the 10th grade! My favorite movie is Space Jam! I bump a lot of Nelly. A lot. You can't bump Nelly in a minivan, Lucy! I don't want a minivan!
LUCY: Your favorite movie is Space Jam? Really?
CHARLOTTE: Lucy, not the point!
LUCY: Kind of the point.
CHARLOTTE: Luce!
LUCY: Charlotte. It's going to be fine. You want children!
CHARLOTTE: I can't want children; I *am* children!
LUCY: Char.
CHARLOTTE: Moms are always sharing their ice cream; I don't want to do that! And saying that their kid is in the whatevereth percentile for...I don't even know, what do they do that for?!
LUCY: Growth, I think?
CHARLOTTE: I don't want to start speaking in weeks! "Oh hey, that kid is cute, how old is he? He's eighty-four and a half weeks." I don't want to do that!
LUCY: I don't think that's a requirement.
CHARLOTTE: What if I don't have a cute baby! What if my baby is ugly and I just have to love it anyway!
LUCY: Well, you and Luke are both attractive people, so I really think it'll probably be fine…
CHARLOTTE: Probably?! Lucy! I can't do this. I can't be a mom.
LUCY: Charlotte. Breathe, okay? Focus. You want to be a mom. You love the idea of being a mom; you've wanted to be a mom since you were like nine. If anyone is read to be a mom--
CHARLOTTE: *(surprised, but calmly cuts her off)* Lucy. My water broke.
LUCY: You brought a water? Wait like your *water* water? Now!? It broke now? In my kitchen!? I just mopped!
CHARLOTTE: That's really your first priority right now?
LUCY: What SHOULD be my priority?
CHARLOTTE: Uh. Luke? Cab?
LUCY: Luke drives a cab?!
CHARLOTTE: No, call one!
(back of the cab; Charlotte is having contractions and freaking out again; Lucy tries to help her with her breathing)
LUCY: Heee. Hooo.

CHARLOTTE: Can we go any faster?!
LUCY: In and out, Char. You got it.
CHARLOTTE: *(squeezing Lucy's fingers)* Why does giving birth have to feel like squatting on dynamite?!
LUCY: You can do this, Charlotte. It's going to be fine.
CHARLOTTE: *(mid-contraction)* You really...think it's...going to be fine?
LUCY: I really do. Besides. When you've got a baby, you can finally sing that lullabye to somebody other than me at sleepaway camp.

FLASHBACK *(Lucy is on the top bunk at camp (can't sleep) Charlotte is on the bottom).*
LUCY: Charlotte? You awake?
CHARLOTTE: No.
LUCY: Char.
CHARLOTTE: What's wrong?
LUCY: Do you think there's really a sea monster in the lake?
CHARLOTTE: I think it would be a lake monster because it's a lake.
LUCY: So you think there is one?
CHARLOTTE: Luce. I think you ate too many s'mores on that treated wood. Go to sleep.
LUCY: But if there is a monster, you think it'll stay in the lake?
CHARLOTTE: Do you want to sleep in my bunk?
LUCY: I don't want to be a baby.
CHARLOTTE: Oh just get down here!
LUCY: You sure?
CHARLOTTE: Now, please. So we can go to sleep. *(Lucy climbs in with Charlotte)* Still scared?
LUCY: Sorta.
CHARLOTTE: Okay. *(clears throat)*
LUCY: What are you doing?
CHARLOTTE: I'm gonna' sing to you, so just shut up, okay? *You are my sunshine--*

BACK TO BABY FLASHBACK
CHARLOTTE: I can't believe you remember that.
LUCY: I was scared. It helped. Maybe it'll help now.
CHARLOTTE: Now? You want to sing now?
LUCY: Yeah, come on. *(starts the song; Charlotte complies, but clearly doesn't want to) You are my…*
CHARLOTTE: (in pain/annoyed) *sunshine*
LUCY: (encouraging) *my only…*
CHARLOTTE: (mid-contraction) *sunshine*

PRESENT
CHARLOTTE: You know my dad used to sing that song to me?

LUCY: I remember.
CHARLOTTE: My dad was the coolest.
LUCY: He was the best.
CHARLOTTE: Luke's a pretty solid second, though.
LUCY: Yeah, you landed a good one.
CHARLOTTE: He's not a plane, Luce.
LUCY: Whatever. He's great.
CHARLOTTE: He is pretty great.
LUCY: You've always been great at stuff.
CHARLOTTE: I don't think there was much skill involved in marrying Luke. It was just right.
LUCY: Still.
CHARLOTTE: *You're* great at things.
LUCY: Like what?
CHARLOTTE: I mean you owned that Backstreet Boys song at the 7th grade talent show.
LUCY: You did my choreography the night before.
CHARLOTTE: Yeah, I also pierced your ears that night, remember?
LUCY: I can't forget. They're still crooked!

FLASHBACK *(Charlotte stands behind Lucy, needle in hand, ready to pierce her ears).*
CHARLOTTE: Okay ready?
LUCY: No!
CHARLOTTE: It's not even going to hurt.
LUCY: You're putting holes in my head!
CHARLOTTE: In your ears! I'm not shooting you!
LUCY: You really think this is going to work?
CHARLOTTE: Yeah, totally.
LUCY: And you've done this before? Right?
CHARLOTTE: Um...yeah…
LUCY: Charlotte!
CHARLOTTE: Well, technically!
LUCY: Technically?!
CHARLOTTE: Princess Lilac's turned out great!
LUCY: Princess Lilac is a doll!
CHARLOTTE: With perfectly pierced ears! Just trust me!
LUCY: What if I die?!
CHARLOTTE: Don't be a drama queen. Do you want pierced ears or not?
LUCY: Yes…
CHARLOTTE: Okay. Ready? One. Two.
LUCY: Ouch!

PRESENT
CHARLOTTE: See, you survived. And your ears are pierced.

LUCY: My earrings always hang crooked.
CHARLOTTE: You're gonna' be an old lady in the nursing home still complaining about your ears.
LUCY: Yeah, but probably more about my ability to use them.
CHARLOTTE: Probably true. Your hearing is terrible *now*. By then everybody will have to holler at you.
LUCY: It'd be nice if *you* were there hollering at me.

FLASHFORWARD *(Lucy and Charlotte in the nursing home; using walkers)*
LUCY: Charlotte!
CHARLOTTE: What?
LUCY: They forgot my oatmeal!
CHARLOTTE: You got oatmeal?
LUCY: Who?
CHARLOTTE: What?
LUCY: Oatmeal!
CHARLOTTE: Forget the oatmeal. Whatcha wanna do today?
LUCY: What's that program on The Netflix that I like?
CHARLOTTE: With the man?
LUCY: And the shoes. And the map.
CHARLOTTE: The weather channel?
LUCY: Not feathers! The map!
CHARLOTTE: We are not watching TV! It's Saturday!
LUCY: Stingray?
CHARLOTTE: Saturday!
LUCY: At the zoo?
CHARLOTTE: It's the weekend, Lucy!
LUCY: I love the zoo!
CHARLOTTE: Hey, how 'bout I race ya back to the rooms?
LUCY: Who's got shrooms?
CHARLOTTE: Race. To your room!
LUCY: Oh with your old hips, I'll leave 'ya in the dust!
CHARLOTTE: I'm gonna' kick your wrinkled old butt!
LUCY: On your mark
CHARLOTTE: Get set!
LUCY: Here we go!
(they move VERY slowly down the hall)
CHARLOTTE: I told ya'! Eat my shorts, grandma!
LUCY: You just wait ya old bat, I'm comin' alive now!

PRESENT
CHARLOTTE: It's a nice thought. Being old together.

LUCY: *(starting to get sad)* Yeah...it's a great thought.
CHARLOTTE: That walker really gives you character, ya know?
LUCY: (sadly) *You* give me character.
CHARLOTTE: Luce...
LUCY: I know. Happy thoughts.
CHARLOTTE: I'm not happy about this either, you know. I didn't sign up for this.
LUCY: Yeah, I know.
CHARLOTTE: Like...what's gonna' happen to my kids? What's gonna' happen to Luke? What if they can't do it without me, Lucy?
LUCY: They can. I promise.
CHARLOTTE: How do you know?
LUCY: Because they'll have me.
CHARLOTTE: And you'll take care of them? Always?
LUCY: Always.
CHARLOTTE: And Sam and Lizzie, you'll tell them about me? You'll tell them I was cool and I was a great mom, and I loved them?
LUCY: Every single day.
CHARLOTTE: And you won't bring up that time I almost left Sammy in the cart at Target?
LUCY: *(laughs)* I swear. I'll talk about you so much they'll feel like you're there.
CHARLOTTE: I *really* want to be there.
LUCY: I really *want* you to be there.
CHARLOTTE: And you'll make sure that Luke like cooks dinner and washes their sheets more than once a year?
LUCY: He will.
CHARLOTTE: *(brief pause - gets choked up)* I love him so much.
LUCY: I'll take care of him.
CHARLOTTE: Okay. But don't tease him too much when he does things wrong. And don't hover, but check on him, okay? And someday...like eighty years from now...if he wants to date or whatever...tell him it's okay. Be encouraging. And…
LUCY: Charlotte. *(takes her hand)* I love you.
CHARLOTTE: I love you too.
LUCY: I'm going to miss you forever. Honestly. Forever.
CHARLOTTE: You're my best friend, Lucy.
LUCY: You're mine.
CHARLOTTE: Luce, one more thing? Sing to them? To Sam and Lizzie? Please?
LUCY: I promise.
(Charlotte and Lucy hold hands and sing "You Are My Sunshine" after "when skies are gray" Charlotte closes her eyes and stops singing. Lucy finishes the song without her.)
CHARLOTTE & LUCY: *(sing) You are my sunshine, my only sunshine. You make me happy when skies are gray.*
LUCY: *(sings) You'll never know dear, how much I love you. Please don't take my sunshine away.*